



2025

Year in review



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Introduction

Cybersecurity allows us to inhabit the new world shaped by the digital revolution and, as an enabling factor, it is at the same time an essential and indispensable element of that world.

Within the digital environment, and through it, institutional, economic and social actors operate through systems, networks and IT infrastructures to pursue objectives that concern citizens, entrepreneurs and Public Administrations; in other words, the national community as a whole. For this reason, cyberspace must be both regulated and protected.

Cyberspace is, however, a fast-changing domain, marked by local and global frictions and conflicts, which is constantly evolving in response to technological innovation, changing patterns of living and working as well as to new modes of wealth creation.

In recent years, robotics, artificial intelligence, data science and digital platforms have greatly expanded the potential of the digital dimension. This progress, however, has been accompanied by a sharp increase in the aggressiveness of cyber threats. Actors driven by economic opportunism, State or State-sponsored actors, as well as ideologically motivated hackers, populate cyberspace with differing intentions, means and capabilities, fueling cybercrime. New offensive tools, or the malicious use of existing ones, supported by disruptive technologies, have made the threat even more dangerous and harmful.

The National Cybersecurity Agency (Agenzia per la cybersicurezza nazionale-ACN) is tasked, in essence, with ensuring Italy's systemic resilience, with the primary goal of safeguarding national interests in the digital domain.

This task is both pursued by the Agency in accordance with the powers and responsibilities conferred upon it by its founding law and subsequent legislation and is

carried out in cooperation with the other actors involved in cyber protection.

The main directions of this action are those identified and described in the most authoritative European and international indexes which analyze the success factors underlying national cybersecurity policies.

These factors include the definition of a cybersecurity strategy, the existence of a national cybersecurity agency, the presence of a Computer Security Incident Response Team (CSIRT), cooperation between the public and the private sectors, the development of a skilled and qualified workforce and, finally, the promotion of awareness among citizens of the seriousness of cyber risk. With this regard, Italy has already reached a level of maturity that places it among the most advanced nations. This is highlighted by the facts that this Year in review, like the one before it, seeks to illustrate.

By the end of 2025, the Agency completed, thanks also to the decisive contribution of other Administrations, 60 of the 82 measures included in the 2022-2026 National Cybersecurity Strategy. It has significantly strengthened its workforce with highly specialized units and is continuing to structure its Services and Departments in line with developments in the national and European legal frameworks. Through CSIRT Italia, it devoted intense efforts to countering cyber threats, which appear on the rise also as a result of the increasing number of incident notifications linked to the implementation of Law No. 90 of 2024 and NIS2. In terms of public-private partnership, the ACN has reached cooperation agreements with academic and industrial entities, fostering a productive dialogue between research, innovation and technology transfer. Finally, it has implemented numerous awareness-raising and training initiatives tailored for different segments of society, giving rise to a form of civic education on cyber risk.

The relentless evolution of technologies, and in particular

the emergence of new ones, lies at the root of the ongoing interplay between development and regulation. The European Union's Artificial Intelligence Act represents only the apex of this phenomenon, shaped by geopolitical dynamics, while further regulatory developments are already emerging in the background, also aimed at simplifying the implementation of compliance obligations.

The Agency is deeply attentive to the regulatory implications of digital transformation. In 2025, in addition to the already mentioned implementation of NIS2, the ACN was designated as the market surveillance Authority for artificial intelligence and, in this capacity, it took part in various initiatives launched within the AI Board.

Moreover, ongoing cooperation with European Union institutions, focused on sharing knowledge, information and best practices, remains essential to refining national response to cyber threats.

In Italy, the Agency's defensive action, whose weight and prestige have grown within the European CSIRT and CyCLoNe networks, has made it possible to repel and contain thousands of cyberattacks, while also mitigating their effects. In 2025, although malicious cyber events increased by 38%, cyber incidents, meaning attacks with confirmed impact, increased by a much smaller margin, amounting to only 7%.

The Agency's coordination role was reflected, among others, in the sharing of information on hostile phenomena with other cybersecurity actors. The National Cybersecurity Cell (Nucleo per la cybersicurezza-NCS), convened at least monthly and always in the immediate aftermath of particularly critical events, allowed the Agency to provide consistently updates on the growing number of attacks, the exposed digital surface, the typology of events – including DDoS attacks, phishing, ransomware, data and credential

exfiltration – as well as the vulnerabilities identified and alerting campaigns conducted.

In the digital domain, as in the physical one, security is based on principles of prevention and maximum precaution. Technological scrutiny conducted to protect the Cyber National Security Perimeter (Perimetro di sicurezza nazionale cibernetica-PSNC) has enabled the entities within its constituency to use, in highly sensitive contexts, IT goods and services whose reliability and robustness were verified prior to deployment. In 2025, testing activities also led to the identification of dozens of zero-day vulnerabilities.

With regard to research and innovation, the Agency supported innovative startups, doctoral programs and research projects also as a way to foster technological autonomy. Moreover, its commitment in this area is also pursued by contributing national capabilities to the development of a European technological stack.

It is within this context that the High-Performance Computing (HPC) infrastructure known as Megaride, inaugurated in June 2025, was developed through a long-standing collaboration with the Cineca consortium. Among other functions, it serves as an infrastructure supporting industry, research and national security while its inclusion within the IT4LIA AI Factory project highlights its strong connection with the European joint undertaking for High-Performance Computing.

ACN's involvement at the international level is also reflected in the activities carried out by the group of cyber experts established during the 2024 Italian G7 presidency. In 2025, Canada hosted meetings of this new cooperation format, focused on addressing the most current issues related to the harmonization of cybersecurity standards, the protection of artificial intelligence systems and models and energy infrastructures.

Through data and narratives aimed at illustrating the scope of the Agency's activities, the Year in review traces what has been accomplished over the course of the last year, conveying the importance they have held for the country's digital surface.

I cannot conclude these introductory remarks without expressing sincere and deeply deserved appreciation to all the Agency's staff, whose high level of professionalism and strong sense of responsibility are gratefully acknowledged.

Finally, it is equally important to recall the full support expressed by the Government, which has guided the Agency's action. The Parliament has also paid significant attention toward the ACN. For all these reasons, I address my respectful gratitude to both institutions.

Bruno Frattasi



1. Evolution of the cybersecurity legislation

Ensuring an adequate level of cybersecurity and cyber resilience is a complex task, especially in light of an increasingly pervasive threat landscape and of the growing diffusion and continuous evolution of digital technologies. In this context, one of the primary and most important areas of action of the National Cybersecurity Agency (ACN) concerns the development and maintenance of a legal framework that may cope with the challenges the country is facing and updated in line with the most recent developments at the European level.

Recognizing that every technological innovation brings both risks and opportunities, regulation must anticipate, support and guide the digital transition, placing cybersecurity protection at its core. Cybersecurity has become a crucial factor in ensuring overall systemic resilience.

The national legislator assigned to the ACN a central role through several legislative measures addressing different aspects of digital security. A recent example is the law on artificial intelligence (Law No. 132/2025) which, in regulating the use of AI in Italy, identifies cybersecurity as a key enabling pillar for the responsible and secure deployment of this technology. At the same time, the Agency worked to consolidate the regulatory framework introduced by Law No. 90/2024, with particular attention to digital technology procurement processes, which must meet strict requirements to safeguard national security and the country's strategic interests.

The year 2025 also represented a key milestone in advancing the full implementation of the national NIS framework. The new framework extended cybersecurity obligations to thousands of public and private entities, which are now required to actively contribute to the

protection of national cybersecurity. Throughout this process, the ACN acted in accordance with the principles of gradual implementation and proportionality, providing continuous support to the entities subject to the new rules.

With Law No. 132/2025, a new milestone was added to Italy's national regulatory pathway for emerging technologies. In line with the principles of the AI Act (Regulation (EU) 2024/1689), the law introduces in the national legal framework the first provisions governing the use of artificial intelligence systems and models by adopting a clearly human-centric approach. Beyond establishing general principles, scope of application and strategic guidelines for the development of AI in support of national innovation, the law also defines the architecture of Italy's governance model. Within this framework, the ACN is identified as one of the central pillars. As Market Surveillance Authority and single point of contact, it is entrusted with supervisory and control functions, as well as sanctioning powers. The governance model also assigns a role to the Agency for Digital Italy (AgID), designated as the Notifying Authority. In addition, AgID and ACN are jointly responsible for establishing and managing regulatory experimentation environments (so-called sandboxes) within their respective areas of competence, without prejudice to the specific responsibilities of other Public Administrations. The ACN is also tasked with promoting and developing initiatives aimed at enhancing the use of artificial intelligence as a strategic resource to improve national cybersecurity.

The law is further strengthened by a broad and forward-looking industrial policy perspective. It provides for the ACN to take part in the governance bodies of venture capital funds that invest risk capital in companies operating in Italy in strategically important sectors, including artificial intelligence, cybersecurity, quantum technologies and telecommunications systems.

With the adoption of the Prime Minister's Decrees (April 30th and October 2nd, 2025), both proposed by the Agency, the before-mentioned Law No. 90/2024 was further implemented. Through these measures, a coherent framework was established to strengthen cybersecurity specifications in the procurement of technologies linked to the protection of national strategic interests. The framework defines essential cybersecurity requirements that public and private entities must consider when acquiring ICT goods and services, with the aim of mitigating cyber risks. It also introduces preferential criteria (i.e. scores), in

cases involving national security, for proposals and tenders that rely on trusted cybersecurity technologies developed in Italy, in EU or NATO countries, or in selected partner third countries. With the October 2nd 2025 Decree, the scope of application was extended to include mobile communications systems and services, including 4G and 5G networks and their technological evolutions, reflecting the growing strategic importance of next generation mobile infrastructures as enablers of essential services, critical state functions and high impact systemic applications.

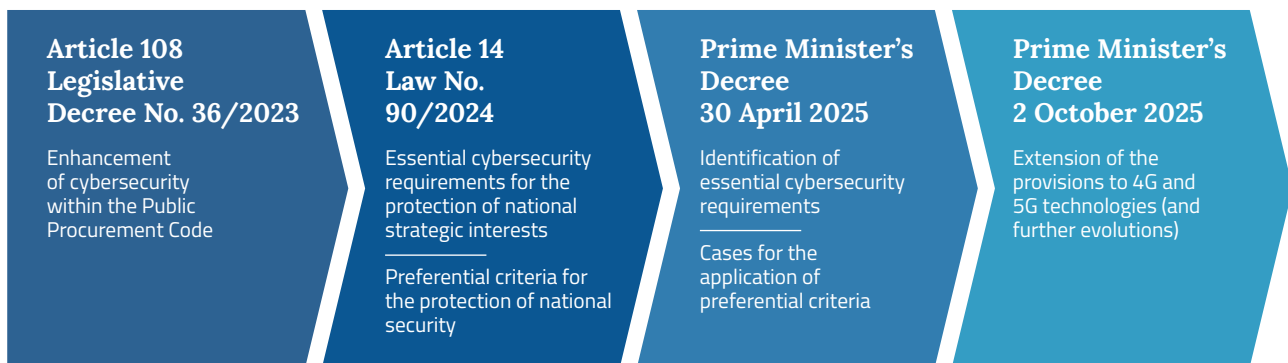


Figure 1 – Procurement in cybersecurity: key milestones

In 2025, the ACN continued to foster the implementation of the new EU NIS Directive architecture framework, further strengthening cybersecurity across the country. The regulatory framework was developed following an extensive process of engagement with both public and private stakeholders, based on a systematic approach that took national specificities into account while ensuring proportionality and gradual implementation of the European legislation.

This approach followed a step-by-step implementation path for the new obligations, aligned with the adoption of secondary legislation and the progressive fulfilment of compliance requirements by the entities concerned. Throughout this process, the Agency, acting as the NIS National Competent Authority, provided strategic direction and coordination, while ensuring continuous support to NIS national entities to promote consistent application of the rules and a steady increase in the overall level of national cyber resilience.



Figure 2 – NIS Implementation Steps

The first major obligation for NIS entities in 2025 was the registration on the digital platform made available by the ACN. This process enabled the establishment and consolidation of the national register of essential and important entities. Following the verification of more than 30.000 self declarations submitted during the initial registration phase, the number of entities subject to the NIS framework was at the end of the first registration procedure significantly expanded, compared to the previous regime, reaching more than 21.800 entities across different sectors.

Besides, the ACN also contributed both to the national implementation of existing EU legislation and to negotiations on new legislative initiatives. In this regard, close coordination with other national authorities was essential in defining Italy's negotiating positions on European Commission proposals shaping the EU cybersecurity regulatory framework.

2. The cyber threat landscape

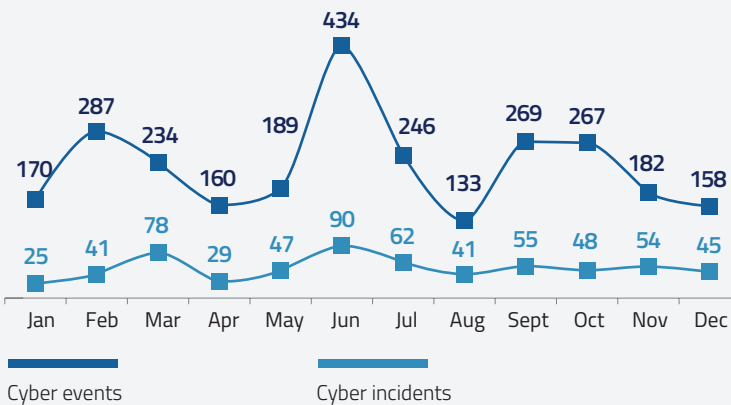
In 2025, the ACN observed a significant increase in malicious cyber activity. This rise in cyber events, however, was not matched by a proportional increase in incidents resulting in confirmed impacts to public and private entities.

The growth in observed indicators is linked to multiple factors, including CSIRT Italia's enhanced detection capabilities and the ongoing geopolitical tensions, which

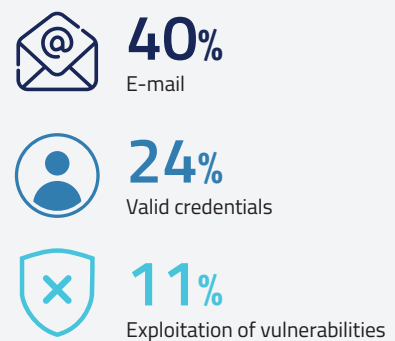
continue to have repercussions in the cyber domain. A further contribution derives from the gradual expansion of notification obligations, which has increased overall visibility of the cyber threat, particularly through the full implementation of Law No. 90/2024. At the same time, the more limited growth in relevant incidents reflects the effectiveness of CSIRT Italia's early warning and targeted alerting activities, supported by guidance on mitigation measures, as well as a gradual improvement of entities' defensive capabilities, driven by higher risk awareness.

2025 at a glance

Cyber events and incidents



Main attack vectors



Top 3 impacted sectors

Public Administration

Telecommunication

Tech

Top 3 threats

DDoS

Data exposure

Phishing

In 2025 the CSIRT Italia handled a total of 2.729 cyber events, corresponding to a monthly average of around 227 events, up from 165 in 2024, with a peak of 434 events recorded in June. Of these, 615 were classified as incidents, with a monthly average of approximately 51 incidents, slightly higher than the 48 incidents reported in 2024.

The peaks observed in February, June, September and October were primarily linked to four distinct DDoS attack campaigns claimed by various hacktivist groups operating in the context of the Russia-Ukraine conflict and, more broadly, within the current international geopolitical environment. The data shows that these peaks in events did not translate into a corresponding increase in the number of incidents, confirming the limited impact of such campaigns.

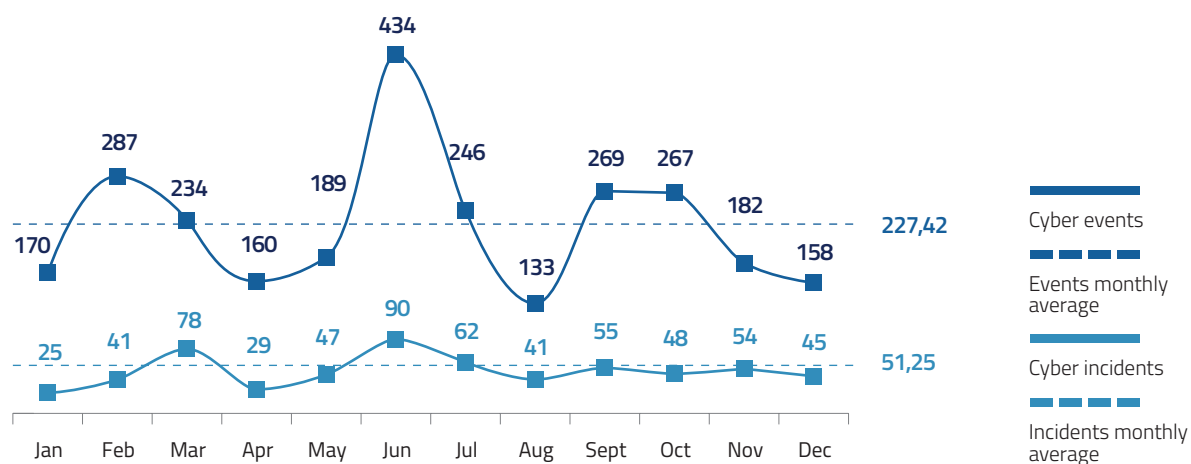


Figure 3 – Distribution of cyber events and incidents in 2025

Analysis and classification of the 2.729 recorded cyber events made possible to identify the main threat types, as shown in Figure 4. From a quantitative perspective, DDoS attacks emerged as the most prevalent threat, followed by the unauthorized exposure of data and phishing campaigns.

The analysis of the threat landscape shows that the increase in events is mainly due to a rise in DDoS (Distributed Denial of Service) attack campaigns targeting national entities, which in most cases did not produce relevant effects. An increase was also

recorded in events involving the unauthorized exposure of previously exfiltrated data, as well as in phishing and spearphishing campaigns, whose scale and sophistication are increasingly amplified by the use of artificial intelligence-based tools.

Threat types should not be considered as rigid or mutually exclusive categories, as a single event may involve multiple threat vectors. For example, phishing campaigns may be aimed at distributing malware, which in turn can evolve into ransomware related incidents.

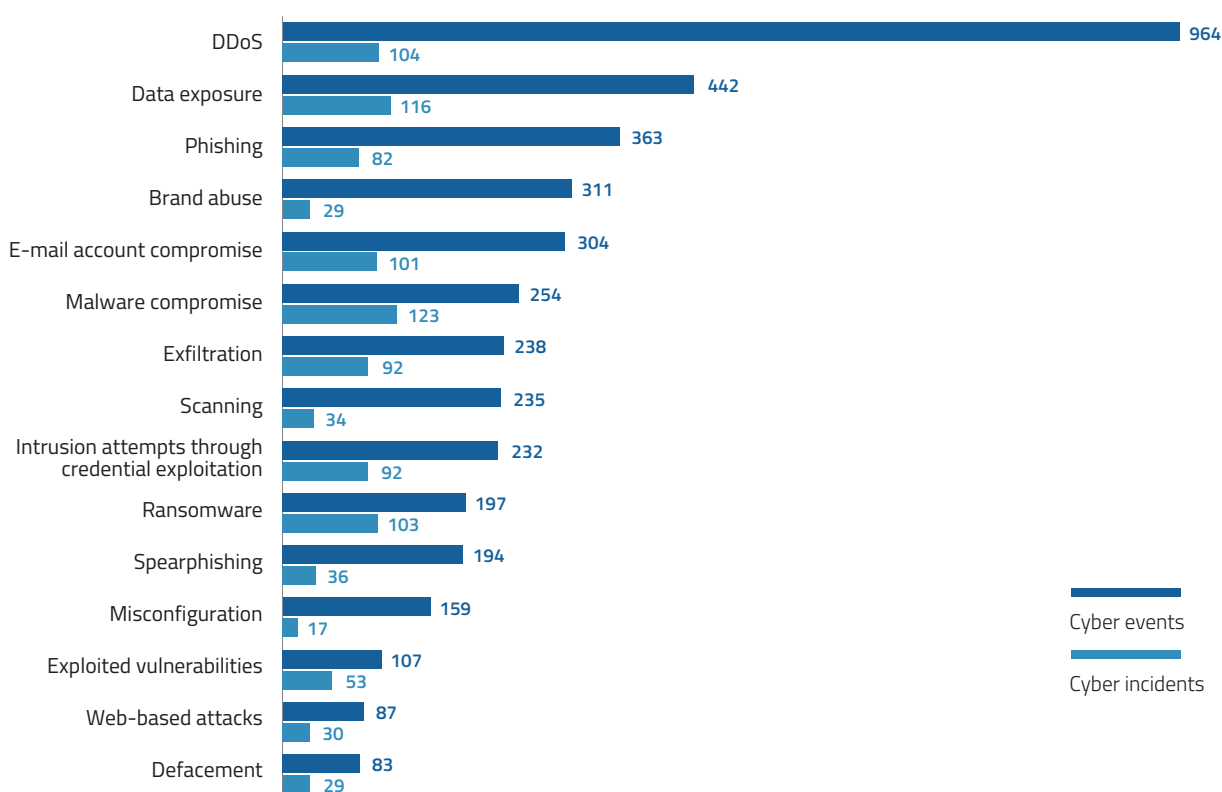


Figure 4 – Threat types detected in cyber events and incidents (Top 15)

With regard to the sectors affected, Public Administrations, at both central and local level, emerge as the most frequent targets, followed by the telecommunications sector, as shown in Figure 5. When interpreting these data, it should be noted that, given

its institutional mandate, the ACN has greater visibility with respect to Public Administrations and the critical sectors identified under the applicable regulatory framework.

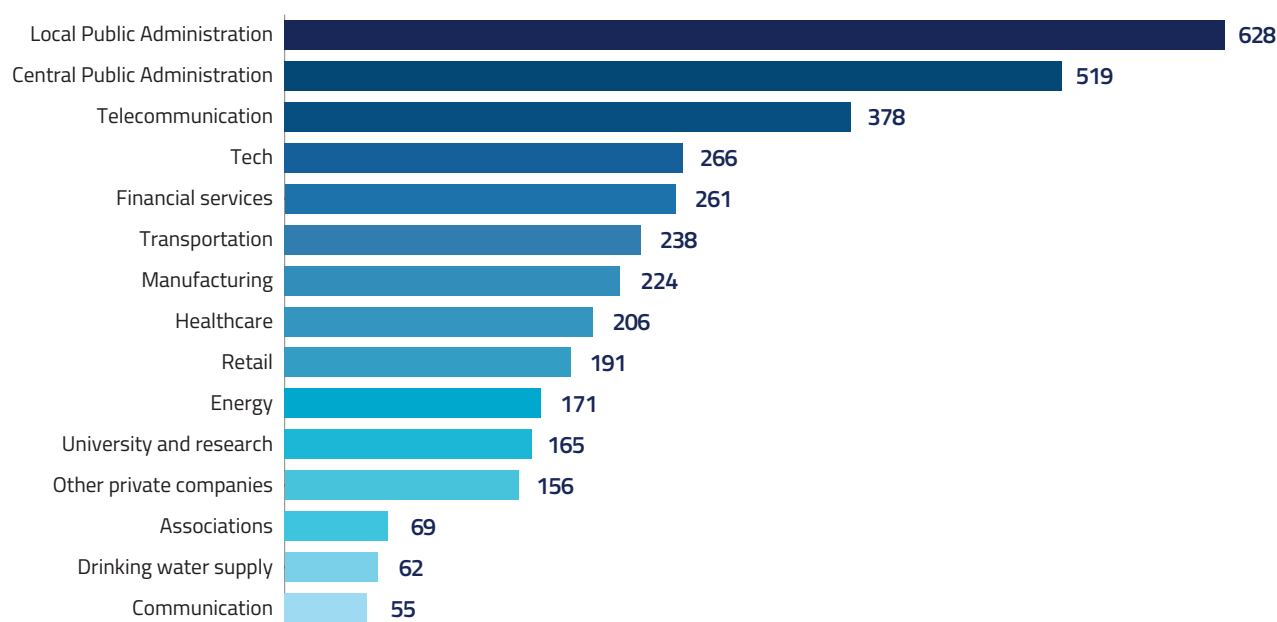


Figure 5 – Cyber events by victim's economic sector (Top 15)

In 2025, the Agency detected 1.140 cyber events affecting national Public Administrations. Of these, 196 cases, corresponding to around 17% of the total, were classified as incidents. This marks an increase compared to the 756 events recorded in 2024, mainly due to the DDoS campaigns previously described and to the ACN's expanded visibility. The distribution of cyber events affecting Public Administrations shows that the largest part involved central Administrations and constitutional or constitutionally relevant bodies. This concentration reflects the central role that these entities play within the national institutional framework, as well as their extensive digital exposure in terms of infrastructures, services and visibility in the cyber domain.

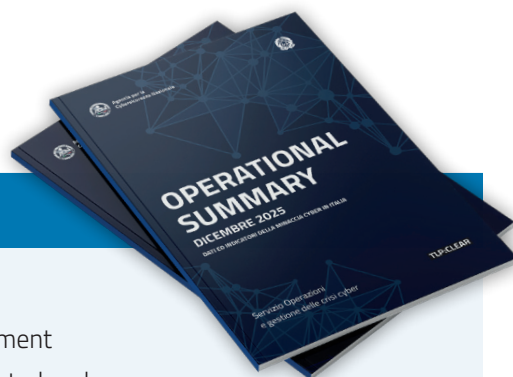
The ACN also carries out proactive monitoring activities aimed at identifying vulnerabilities, insecure configurations, exposed assets and indicators of compromise that may enable hostile actions or be already exploited. In

2025, these included approximately 2.457 phishing websites imitating those of over 1.000 public and private organizations, 10.312 potentially compromised IT devices or services linked to malicious activity and 31.050 devices or services exposing potential risks such as vulnerable software versions. Thousands of notifications were sent by ACN-CSIRT Italia, mainly to private-sector entities, to support timely mitigation actions. This approach allowed preventive measures to be taken before such conditions evolve into full scale incidents.

In more complex cases, the Agency provides direct support to the victims of cyber incidents through the Digital Forensic Incident Response (DFIR) teams of the CSIRT Italia. This support may involve on-site or remote assistance, aimed at supporting incident management and mitigating impacts through the identification of appropriate containment measures and the restoration of compromised services.

Operational Summary

The ACN publishes the Operational Summary, an analytical document issued monthly and supplemented by two semester editions. The document is designed to collect and systematize the main cyber phenomena detected and handled by the CSIRT Italia, serving as a stable information asset to support analysis of the evolving cyber threat landscape. The Operational Summary enables the development of data and indicators on the most affected sectors and the prevailing types of cyber threats. The document is also published in English and is available for download on the Agency's website.



3. The Agency in the institutional framework

In a continuously evolving regulatory and threat landscape, the ACN's central role in coordinating the multiple actors involved in the country's cybersecurity and cyber resilience was further reaffirmed through multiple actions carried out by the Agency.

In the year under review, this role was exercised through the leadership of, and participation in, several interministerial coordination mechanisms aimed at fostering structured cooperation at the strategic and operational level. Alongside the Interministerial Committee for Cybersecurity (CIC), which provides strategic direction for national cybersecurity policies, the ACN promoted dialogue among Ministries and other Administrations through key coordination bodies, including the National Cybersecurity Cell (Nucleo per la cybersicurezza-NCS).

The CIC is responsible for proposing cybersecurity policy guidelines to the Prime Minister, who chairs the Committee, overseeing the implementation of the National Cybersecurity Strategy, monitoring ACN's economic and financial management and promoting initiatives aimed at strengthening cybersecurity. During the year in review, the CIC met four times, in February, April, October and December. Its activity focused in particular on matters related to the Cyber National Security Perimeter (Perimetro di sicurezza nazionale cibernetica-PSNC), including an opinion on a regulatory measure that expanded the taxonomy of incidents subject to mandatory notification by entities included in the PSNC.

Building on the work carried out in previous years, the

NCS continued to support decision making by enabling an integrated assessment of risk scenarios, aimed at the effective prevention and management of high-impact cyber events and incidents. Following the entry into force of Law No. 132/2025, interinstitutional coordination was further strengthened with the inclusion of AgID within the NCS.

In 2025, the NCS continued to enhance its regular meetings with sessions dedicated to its Administrations, thematic discussions, and sector-specific focuses. These meetings promoted the exchange of organizational models, cybersecurity best practices, and case studies, enabling shared perspectives among Administrations. The NCS also engaged external experts to address cross-cutting issues, including the ethical and social implications of artificial intelligence and the relationship between privacy and cybersecurity. Additionally, sessions extended to private operators managing strategic national infrastructures strengthened public-private dialogue, particularly in the energy and air transport sectors, fostering shared awareness of evolving cyber threats and mitigation measures.

NCS meetings in restricted composition, by enabling a quicker and more confidential information sharing among the Administrations called to attend it on a case-by-case basis, provided a shared impact assessment of the most urgent cyber risk situations, supporting their coordinated management and ensuring timely and appropriate information flow to the political leadership.

In 2025, the NCS met a total of 21 times, with 10 meetings held in ordinary composition and 11 in restricted composition (Figure 6).

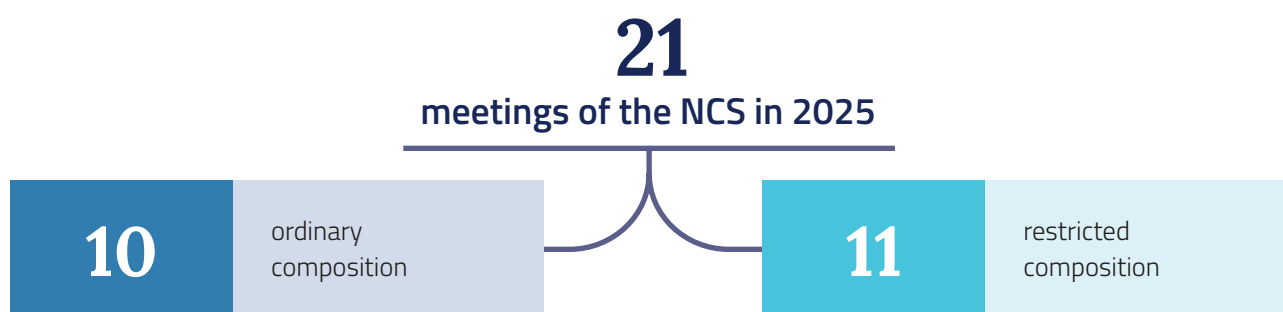


Figure 6 – Analysis of NCS meetings in 2025

In addition, 2025 saw an extensive work carried out by the Working Group for the implementation of the NIS framework and the Working Group for the implementation of the PSNC as they ensured overall coordination of the complex activities related to the definition of the regulatory frameworks. Moreover, the appointment of the new members of the Technical and Scientific Committee (CTS) of the ACN brought the new members to meet three times, focusing on updating the Research and Innovation Agenda for cybersecurity, on the development of cybersecurity skills promoted by the Agency in cooperation with the Ministry of University and Research (see Chapter 5) and on the project aimed at assessing the return on cybersecurity investments.

Equally significant was the ongoing dialogue with the Parliament, within the context of its guidance, oversight and legislative functions. This sustained engagement contributed to the advancement of the national legislative framework on cybersecurity, secure digitalization and the definition of a national regulatory approach to artificial intelligence aligned with the European framework. Moreover, in 2025, the Director General presented ACN's comprehensive perspective in five parliamentary hearings. In two instances, these interventions took place within legislative proceedings that led to the alignment of the national regulatory

framework with several European regulations containing cybersecurity provisions, as well as to the adoption of the above-mentioned national law on artificial intelligence. The Director General was also called upon to contribute to the debate on a range of additional topics, including the cybersecurity aspects of the tax registry, the exploitation of cyberspace by organized crime and the connections between cybersecurity and online gender-based violence.

At the same time, the ACN maintained a strong and continuous presence across the institutional, social and productive landscape, both by organizing and participating in numerous sector-specific events and by expanding cooperation through agreements with public and private entities, with the objective of strengthening the resilience of the national cyber ecosystem.

In addition, the Agency took part in around 60 outreach, information and support events aimed at fostering constructive dialogue with entities operating across the sectors covered by the NIS framework. These initiatives highlighted the role of the NIS discipline as a cornerstone of the country's cyber resilience and supported its effective understanding and adoption by the relevant stakeholders.

FOCUS**The ACN's support to major events: Milano-Cortina 2026 Winter Olympics**

In January 2025, the ACN and the Milano-Cortina 2026 Foundation signed a protocol aimed at contributing to the cybersecurity of the Milano-Cortina 2026 Winter Olympic and Paralympic Games. The agreement provides for monitoring and analysis of cyber threats, exchange of critical information and support in the management of potential cyber crises related to the event.

Given the strategic relevance of the event and the high complexity of ensuring its cybersecurity, dedicated resources were allocated to the ACN through Law Decree No. 96/2025. This measure underscores the critical role of cybersecurity in the context of major international events and confirms the trust placed in the Agency as an essential operational safeguard for the protection of the country's digital surface, tasked with ensuring the security of networks, data and critical services in high-risk environments.

4. Technological security

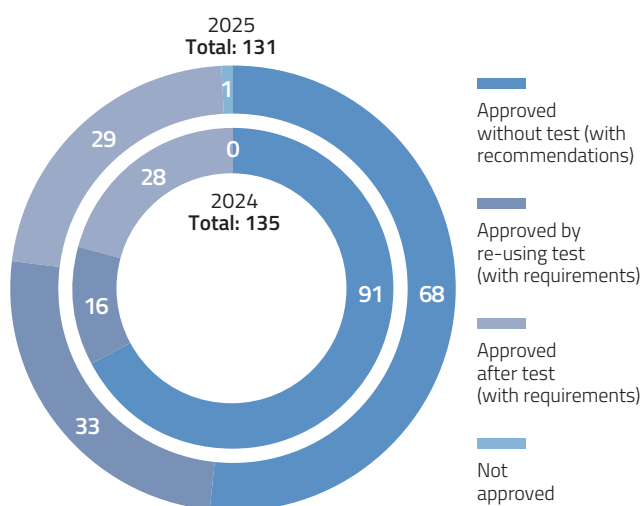
Technological security represents a fundamental element of the country's systemic resilience, both for the protection of critical infrastructures and for ensuring the widespread adoption of trusted and reliable solutions. In a context where zero risk does not exist, it is essential to rely on systems and services that meet clearly defined cybersecurity requirements.

Within this framework, the ACN plays a central role across multiple dimensions. It ensures technological scrutiny in areas that are most critical to national security, as well as certification and conformity activities in line with international standards. These functions are complemented by support for the secure digital transformation of Public Administrations, with a particular focus on the transition to cloud technologies. Across all these areas, robust verification and inspection activities are essential to enable a comprehensive risk assessment.

As part of the implementation of PSNC, the National Evaluation and Certification Centre (CVCN) of ACN carries out the technological scrutiny required for assets relevant to cyber national security. When an entity notifies its intention to acquire an ICT asset for use within the PSNC, the CVCN initiates an administrative procedure that may result in approval for use, possibly subject to specific recommendations or requirements, or in non-approval.

In 2025, the overall volume of administrative procedures remained largely stable compared to the previous year, both in terms of procedures initiated and concluded. At the same time, a significant increase was recorded in approvals based on the re-use of previously conducted tests, reflecting the ability to leverage assessment results collected in earlier years and avoid duplicative testing. By the end of 2025, the number of ongoing procedures increased, mainly due to a rise in notifications submitted in the final part of the year, leading to growth across all procedural phases.

CVCN proceedings concluded in 2025



CVCN proceedings ongoing

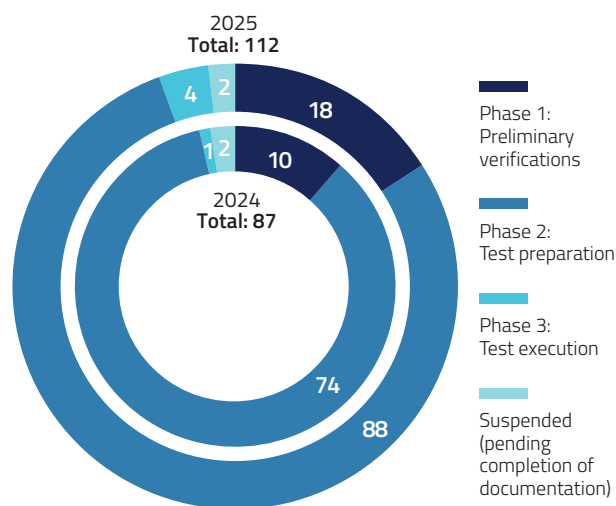


Figure 7 – CVCN procedures concluded and ongoing on December 31: 2025 vs. 2024

With regard to test phase 3 activities, in 2025 the CVCN carried out 29 component tests, identifying 38 zero-day vulnerabilities. Of these, 28 were classified as high or critical severity according to the international CVSS standard. Following notification by the CVCN to

the manufacturers, resolution activities were initiated: discussions are ongoing for 21 vulnerabilities, 11 have been taken in charge for resolution and 6 have already been corrected and published as CVEs.

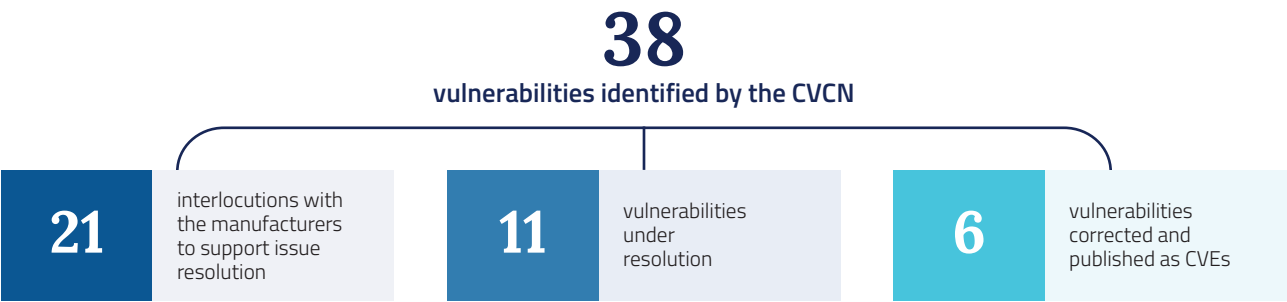


Figure 8 – Status of the zero-day vulnerabilities identified during the test activities under the CVCN framework

To ensure a safer digital environment, cybersecurity certification represents a key instrument even beyond the highly critical domain of PSNC. In Italy, such certifications are issued by the Information Security Certification Body (OCSI) following a rigorous evaluation process, contributing to the reliability and security of ICT products. 2025 marked a transition phase from the National Certification Scheme to the full operational rollout of the European Common Criteria-based certification framework (EUCC), which enables harmonized ICT product certification across the European Union. Within this context, the OCSI launched the final 16 certification processes under the national scheme and issued 10 cybersecurity certificates covering various categories of ICT products, including network devices, signature creation devices, data management applications and operating systems. The remaining certification processes initiated under the national scheme had reached their final stages by the end of 2025. At the same time, certification activities were launched for the first ICT product under the EUCC framework.

The ACN continued to support the broader digital transformation of the Public Administration, driven by the transition to cloud technologies, by defining further cybersecurity rules and mechanisms set out in the Cloud Regulation adopted in 2024. Based on the classification

of data or services carried out by each Administration as data owner, the framework enables a proportionate calibration of requirements and safeguards according to actual risk levels. This approach allows an effective balance between cybersecurity and resilience needs, technological and operational control and requirements related to sovereignty, efficiency and cost effectiveness.

In 2025, the Cloud Regulation reached full maturity and proved its alignment with the evolving technological landscape. Throughout the year, the ACN managed a high volume of qualification procedures for cloud services and infrastructure. Approximately 1.700 cloud services – across IaaS, PaaS and SaaS models – and more than 130 digital infrastructures were granted qualification to support the delivery of cloud services to the Public Administration.

The ACN is also actively involved in the exercise of the Government's special powers (so-called Golden Power), providing technical cybersecurity assessments both in areas of its direct competence, such as 5G technologies and, in other cases, relevant to defense, national security and additional strategic sectors.

In 2025, a significant increase was recorded in the number of notifications submitted under Articles 1

and 2 for which the ACN provided support. The Agency contributed to 370 of the 877 notifications processed, marking a 25% increase compared to the previous year.

Finally, the Agency contributes to strengthening national cryptographic capabilities, taking into account the impending changes linked to the transition to quantum technologies, which may undermine the security of currently deployed solutions. Indeed, also in the context of the provision to establish the National Cryptographic Center mandated by Law No. 90/2024, the ACN actively promotes the use of cryptography as a cybersecurity tool, a goal it pursues also in cooperation with universities and research bodies, other relevant institutions and the industrial sector. Moreover, in 2025, the ACN also continued to expand the "Cryptographic Functions Guidelines", a publication series designed to provide technical details and recommendations on cryptographic schemes and related parameters to be adopted. The two new issues are related to authenticated encryption and transport layer security.

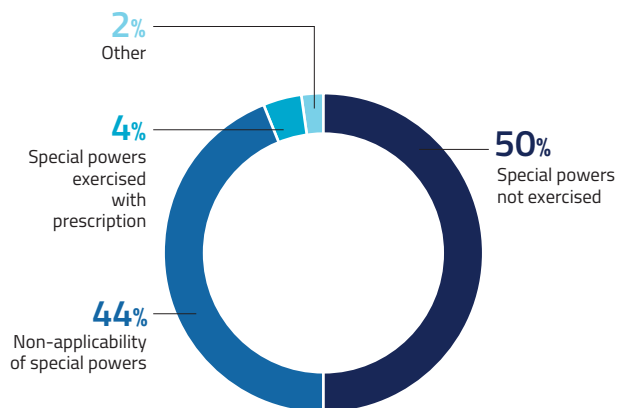


Figure 9 – Outcome of the Golden Power proceedings with ACN's involvement

5. Investment programs to support cybersecurity

In the current context, marked by the progressive digitalization of services and the increasing interconnection of information infrastructures, cybersecurity confirms its strategic importance for the action of the Public Administration and the private sector. The qualitative and quantitative evolution of cyber threats, together with the expansion of the attack surface resulting from the adoption of digital platforms, requires a structural adjustment of policies for the protection of information assets and of the services provided to citizens and businesses.

Within this framework, the definition of investment programs supporting cybersecurity cannot be limited to contingent or purely technological measures. Instead, it must be a structured and coherent strategic process aimed at the systemic management of cyber risk in order to strengthen prevention, detection and incident response capabilities as well as to ensure the continuity of the country's essential functions.

The objective of making Italy more secure from a cybersecurity perspective was also pursued by the ACN in 2025 through investment programmes structured along four main lines of action: strengthening cyber capabilities of Public Administrations, supporting the research and innovation ecosystem including the promotion of technology transfer, ensuring the continuous improvement of national cyber services and laying the foundations for the more effective use of technologies including emerging ones through the management of European funding.

Since 2022, enhancing cyber capabilities of Public Administrations has been a key objective pursued by the ACN also within the framework of the National Recovery and Resilience Plan. Through targeted funding and

support activities, Administrations have implemented projects aimed at improving their cybersecurity posture, reducing vulnerabilities and increasing overall resilience.

In 2025, this effort continued through projects financed under public calls No. 7/2023 and No. 8/2024, addressing both central and local Public Administrations. The support pathway initiated under the PNRR was further reinforced by funding linked to the National Cybersecurity Strategy, in particular Measures No. 55 and No. 33, which contributed to strengthening operational capabilities and to developing regional CSIRTs.

In parallel, the ACN launched new initiatives to protect the Public Administration in partnership with the Istituto Poligrafico e Zecca dello Stato, including a phishing reporting service and a project for a secure national instant messaging platform for Public Administration employees. In 2025, the initial pilot and feasibility phases of these initiatives were completed, laying the groundwork for broader deployment.

As far as supporting the research and innovation ecosystem, during the year, an updated version of the Research and Innovation Agenda for cybersecurity was developed. The document is the result of joint work launched in 2023 by the ACN and the Ministry of university and research, with the aim of supporting and guiding research and innovation choices, promoting public-private collaboration and strengthening national cyber capabilities. The Agenda incorporates key Italian and European strategic priorities, including those stemming from recent regulatory developments in cybersecurity. The updated Agenda expands its scope by reinforcing its cross-cutting structure, which is now articulated into 6 areas, 18 subareas and 61 priority topics. In this context, 32 new subtopics were added to better address the challenges associated with these technologies and to provide clearer directions for future research and innovation activities.



Another important line of activity to advance research is the program promoting doctoral studies in cybersecurity. In its second edition in 2025, the program provides three-year funding for doctoral projects aligned with the priorities set out in the Research and Innovation Agenda, representing concrete support for research on issues of national interest. In 2025, the ACN launched the second call for proposals with a budget of 3 million euros and awarded 30 scholarships for the PhD cycle starting in the 2025-2026 academic year. The call recorded an increased participation compared to the previous year, with 221 project proposals submitted by 54 universities across the country.

In support of the national innovation ecosystem, the ACN continued its commitment to the Cyber Innovation

Network (CIN), a program launched in 2023 to strengthen industrial, technological and scientific capabilities in cybersecurity. In its third year of implementation, the CIN expanded its network and launched new joint programs to support innovative entrepreneurship, contributing to strengthening the national system and to the consolidation of the cybersecurity industrial value chain.

A sixth cooperation agreement was signed with Alan Advantage in 2025, in addition to the five partnerships already in place in the same year. Since its launch, the CIN has promoted six Call4Startup initiatives with selected operators, offering startups non-repayable grants, networking opportunities and tailored entrepreneurial support.

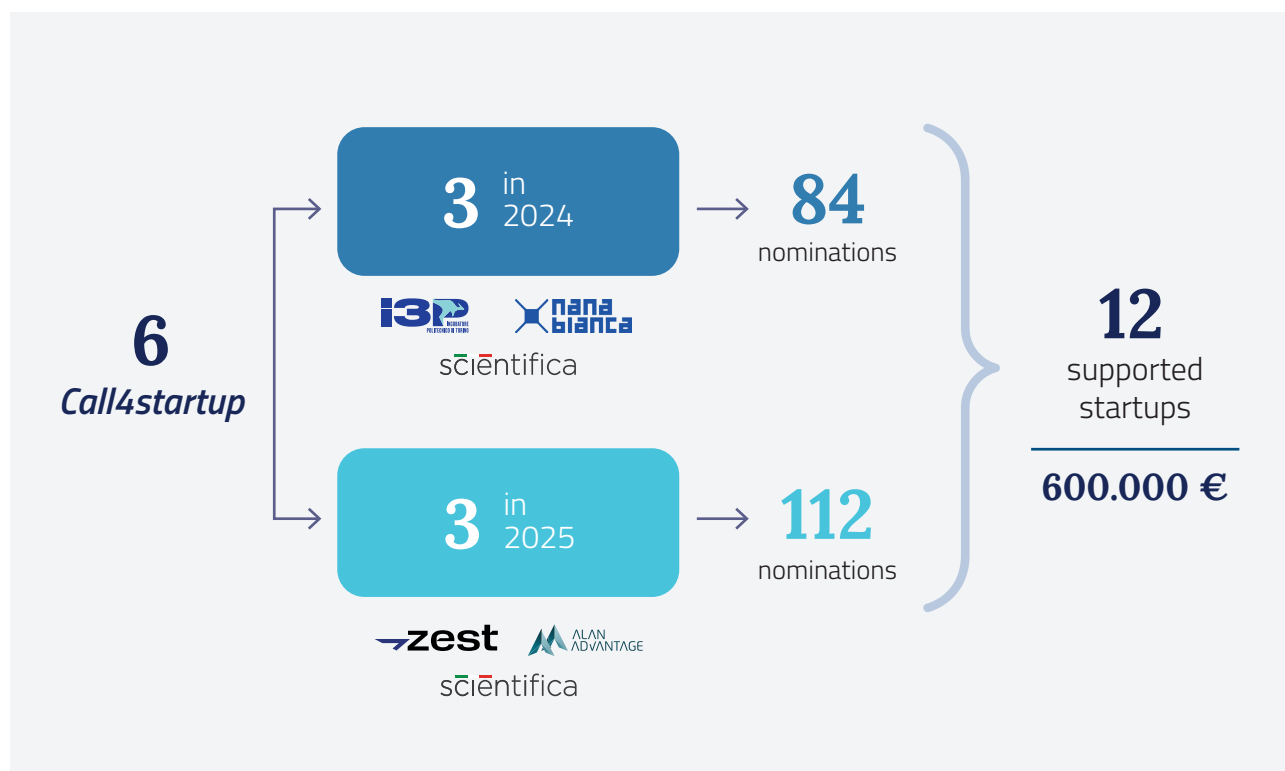


Figure 10 – The 2025 Cyber Innovation Network

With regard to programs supporting national cyber services, the progressive rollout of HyperSOC, the CSIRT network and ISAC Italia enabled the ACN, in 2025, to complete the full operational deployment of core services and to further strengthen their integration within the national cybersecurity ecosystem. These efforts were aimed at ensuring continuity, scalability and long-term effectiveness of response and resilience capabilities.

HyperSOC further consolidated and expanded its operational capacity, with the number of participating entities rising to 37 public and private organizations, including local-level actors. The range of monitored assets and services provided also increased, together with strengthened technological monitoring capabilities through the activation of new services dedicated to advanced threat detection and to the identification of relevant cyber events such as DDoS attacks and phishing campaigns.

FOCUS

High-Performance Computing

In 2025, the ACN continued preparatory activities for the development of the national High-Performance Computing (HPC) infrastructure for cybersecurity, developed in cooperation with the Cineca consortium. A landmark was reached in June, with the inauguration of the Megaride HPC infrastructure in Naples at the University of Naples “Federico II”. The infrastructure is designed to support scientific research and strengthen national cybersecurity through advanced simulation tools based on artificial intelligence and machine learning, enhancing HyperSOC capabilities in prevention, detection and response to cyber attacks. It will also be made available to the productive sector, and in particular to the Cyber Innovation Network.

The CSIRT network was reinforced, enhancing the platforms supporting CSIRT Italia and connecting it with regional CSIRTs established at Regions and Autonomous Provinces thus, ensuring broader territorial coverage. Moreover, the national network was extended to include the CSIRTs of several central Public Administrations. Coordination and communication tools were further strengthened, improving incident analysis and management, real-time information sharing and integration with national and European cyber threat intelligence systems. At the same time, standardized procedures and shared operational capabilities were developed to ensure uniform incident response and effective cooperation across the network.

ISAC Italia, the national Information Sharing and Analysis Center established within the ACN, continued to operate as a hub for sectoral ISACs, supporting the collection, analysis and multisectoral sharing of operational cybersecurity information. During 2025, ISAC Italia continued its activities aimed at further facilitating information sharing at national level through the adoption of a common lexicon. This included

updating the taxonomy of cyber events and continuing information activities on the main cyber threats through the publication of dedicated reports.

The European Union has provided a strong impetus to the development of innovative and technologically advanced projects by making significant financial instruments available to support cybersecurity and the adoption of new technologies, in particular artificial intelligence. In 2025, the ACN continued to perform its role as National Coordination Centre, supporting the European Cybersecurity Competence Centre (ECCC) in the implementation of initiatives aimed at strengthening industrial, technological and research capabilities in cybersecurity. The Agency has participated in 7 calls under the Digital Europe Programme and Horizon Europe, securing related funding opportunities and promoting research and development projects in cooperation with academic and industrial partners.

During 2025, the ACN worked on the implementation of several European funded projects, as illustrated in Figure 11.

	Project	Duration	Total budget	Involved subjects	Main goal
	NCC-IT	2023-2025	€1.996.620	1	Strengthening of the National Coordination Centre
	SECURE	2025-2027	€21.921.036	8	Support for European SMEs in the implementation of the Cyber Resilience Act
	ENSOC	2024-2028	€24.326.757	7	Development of a cross-border platform for the detection and analysis of cyber threats
	CHIEF	2026-2028	€1.970.672	5	Support for the implementation of the Cyber Solidarity Act
	IT4LIA	2025-2028	€420.000.000	13	Development of an Italian AI Factory
	EUSaIR	2024-2026	€1.907.000	13	Support for the implementation of the AI Act
	AKADIMOS	2025-2027	€3.999.660	9	Support for the establishment and operational launch of the European Cybersecurity Skills Academy
	ACN as a coordinator				
	ACN as a partner				

Figure 11 – EU funded projects involving the ACN

6. International cooperation

In line with Government policies and its institutional mandate, the ACN further consolidated and expanded its network of international partnerships, recognizing international cooperation as a key tool for safeguarding Italy's national and economic security in an increasingly complex geopolitical context. In response to the rapid global development of new technologies, the ACN worked with partner agencies to strengthen international policies aimed at preventing and mitigating cyber risks and threats.

At the multilateral level, the Agency continued contributing to established fora, including the G7 Cybersecurity Working Group and the Counter Ransomware Initiative, while also joining new initiatives reflecting the growing interdependence between cybersecurity, economic stability and the protection of strategic national interests.

The ACN continued to work closely with cyber centers and authorities within the G7 Cybersecurity Working Group to strengthen collective capabilities for the protection of cyberspace. In 2025, the Agency supported the agenda of the Canadian G7 Presidency, which expanded interagency cooperation to priority areas including artificial intelligence and cybersecurity, the transition to post-quantum cryptography, incentives for cybersecurity, Internet of Things security and cyber threat information sharing.

In the field of artificial intelligence, the ACN, together with the German Federal Office for Information Security, led the adoption of a shared approach on transparency in AI supply chains based on the Software Bill of Materials (the so-called SBOM) framework and contributed to the development of related technical guidance. The Agency

also supported the definition of operational actions for the transition to post-quantum cryptography and the adoption of the G7 Declaration on IoT security.

Within the Counter Ransomware Initiative (CRI), the Agency strengthened Italy's role by sharing national reflections on ongoing legislative Parliamentary initiatives to counter ransomware, which were recognized as a reference for further discussion among States parties to the CRI. The Agency also reinforced bilateral cooperation on ransomware with partners including the United Kingdom and the Netherlands.

The ACN continued to support the Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation (MAECI) through technical expertise in international cybersecurity cooperation, contributing in particular to the Pall Mall process aimed at promoting responsible use and limiting the proliferation of cyber intrusion tools, to the group of like-minded countries on cyber deterrence organized in Rome and to the four annual sessions of the OSCE Informal Working Group on Cyber Issues, which promotes the implementation of the 16 Confidence Building Measures agreed by its participating States.

At the United Nations level, the ACN participated with the MAECI in the sessions of the Open-Ended Working Group on cybersecurity. In particular, the July session led to the adoption of the final report establishing a new Permanent Mechanism on Information and Communication Technologies in the context of international security and the promotion of responsible State behavior in the use of ICT. The Agency also followed the preparatory work for the establishment of two new international governance mechanisms on artificial intelligence, namely the Independent International Scientific Panel and the Global Dialogue on AI governance.

The ACN recognizes central importance to cooperation

at EU level, both in policy and strategic initiatives and within the main technical fora. In this context, the Agency actively participated in major cybersecurity and artificial intelligence forums, contributing to regulatory, strategic and policy development as well as to operational initiatives.

The Director General met with the European Commissioner for Home Affairs and Migration to exchange views on critical infrastructure protection, the implementation of the NIS2 Directive, the European action plan on the cybersecurity of hospitals and healthcare providers and the fight against ransomware. A further meeting with the Director of Directorate-General for Communications Networks, Content and Technology (DG Connect) focused on the IT4LIA AI Factory project, Italy's proposal to host an AI Gigafactory and the upcoming definition of European standards for artificial intelligence.

Considering the new responsibilities assigned to the Agency in the field of artificial intelligence, 2025 saw significant engagement in the implementation of the AI Act through participation in the AI Board, where Italy is represented by the ACN and AgID, which take part in all related activities. The expansion of the AI Board's thematic subgroups in 2025 also required broad involvement by the ACN, which contributed to 14 of the 15 existing subgroups.

Beyond the field of AI, the ACN participates in a wide range of EU-level forums on cybersecurity, including:

- Horizontal Working Party on Cyber Issues (HWPCI) of the Council of the European Union, a forum dedicated to addressing both regulatory and policy related dossiers. In 2025, work focused in particular on the development of a cyber crisis management plan (so-called Cyber Blueprint) and a cybersecurity plan for the healthcare sector;
- EU-CyCLONe (European Cyber Crisis Liaison Organisation Network), the reference framework for the operational coordination of large-scale cyber incidents and crises. The network ensures regular and structured information sharing among Member States and with EU institutions, bodies and agencies, supporting a coherent and timely European response to cyber crises;
- CSIRTs Network, which bringing together the CSIRTs of the 27 EU Member States is a cornerstone for technical and operational coordination at European level, contributing to the strengthening of prevention, detection and response capabilities in relation to cyber incidents affecting critical infrastructures and essential services;
- NIS Cooperation Group, aiming to promote uniform and effective implementation of the NIS regulatory framework through exchanges among experts from national NIS authorities on cross-cutting and sector-specific issues;
- the already mentioned European Cybersecurity Competence Centre, in the context of which the ACN took on the chairmanship of the working group dedicated to cyber hubs, ensuring continuity with activities launched under the ENSOC and CHIEF projects and building on experience gained through the development of the national cyber hub HyperSOC;
- European Cybersecurity Certification Group (ECCG), a network bringing together national cybersecurity certification authorities of EU Member States to support the implementation of the Cybersecurity Act in the area of cybersecurity certification.

In addition, within ENISA activities, the Agency continued its active participation in the work of the Management Board and of the network of National Liaison Officers.

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Cyber Blueprint

The Council Recommendation on an EU blueprint for cyber crisis management represents an updated version of the previous 2017 framework, whose overall structure was revised considering changes in the European legislative landscape, following the introduction, in particular, of the NIS2 Directive and of the Cyber Solidarity Act. The new Blueprint clarifies the allocation of responsibilities across the different levels of crisis management: the technical level, entrusted to the network of national CSIRTs; the operational level, assigned to EU-CyCLONe for coordination among Member States and EU institutions; and the political-strategic level, exercised by the Council of the European Union, including through the possible activation of the Integrated Political Crisis Response mechanism (IPCR). The document also aims to promote a more structured cooperation between civilian and military actors.

At the bilateral level, the ACN strengthened cooperation with cyber centers from G7 and European countries and from the wider Mediterranean region, enhancing technical collaboration and reinforcing Italy's international role to the benefit of the national cybersecurity ecosystem.

In the year under review, the Agency further strengthened its international engagement through high-level

exchanges, new cooperation agreements and expanded operational partnerships. Two new memorandum of understandings were signed with the Greek cybersecurity authority and with the Ukrainian State Service for Special Communications, reinforcing cooperation on critical infrastructure protection, connectivity security and threat information sharing. Existing agreements with partner agencies in Europe and the Mediterranean area were also actively implemented (Figure 12).



Figure 12 – Status of International agreements signed by the ACN

Operational cooperation expanded alongside the growing partnership network, with a strong focus on cybersecurity preparations for the Milano-Cortina 2026 Winter Olympic Games and on cross-border critical infrastructure security. Dialogue with partners in the Gulf region, Africa and India also progressed.

The ACN continued to promote cyber capacity building in countries of strategic interest. In cooperation with the MAECI, it organised the second National Conference on Cyber Capacity Building and launched the CyberBridge project for African countries, supporting the development of cybersecurity capabilities in line with Italy's international priorities (see Chapter 7).

7. Education and promotion of a cybersecurity culture

In 2025, the ACN continued its efforts to strengthen cybersecurity education among students, enhance workforce skills and promote responsible digital behavior among citizens. Through training, outreach and awareness initiatives developed in cooperation with public and private partners, the Agency supported the dissemination of specialized skills and the consolidation of a strong cybersecurity culture.

In a constantly evolving threat landscape, these activities play a key role in reinforcing national prevention and response capabilities by placing the human factor at the center of cyber defense. Continuous training and awareness raising are essential to foster responsible behavior, improve risk recognition and contribute to the overall cyber resilience of the country.

The ACN placed particular emphasis on strengthening the cybersecurity skills of Public Administration employees by expanding the range of beneficiaries and providing accessible learning resources. These initiatives aimed to enhance the ability of Administrations to recognise and manage cyber risks in an informed and timely manner.

Numerous training initiatives were delivered for the Public Administration, reflecting its high exposure to cyber risk. In particular, the Agency strengthened its cooperation with the National School of Administration by developing structured training programs for central

and local Public Administration staff.

Overall, the initiatives reached more than 1.200 participants, contributing to enhanced administrative capacity and improved cyber protection.

The ACN also continued cooperation with the Ministry of Education and Merit (MIM) following the 2024 memorandum of understanding, supporting initiatives to promote cybersecurity culture in schools. Within this framework, a pilot project was launched to deliver awareness programs for school managers and teachers at all levels, involving more than 900 education staff and addressing topics ranging from basic IT skills to cybersecurity and artificial intelligence.

The ACN also worked on strengthening the cybersecurity skills of diplomatic staff, launching a collaboration with the MAECI to deliver training courses and promote cybersecurity culture in support of cyber diplomacy. The initiative involved the participation of more than 1.100 MAECI employees.

At the same time, in cooperation with the Department for Public Administration, the ACN developed a Vademecum on basic cybersecurity good practices, consisting of twelve practical guidelines for everyday use by public employees. To support its dissemination, the Agency produced short video modules designed to enable accessible and continuous learning across the Public Administration.

Training for Public Administration employees



SNA

+1.200

employees
from the central
and local PA



MIM

+900

school
principals
and teaching



MAECI

+1.100

employees, also
from the
diplomatic career



Vademecum

12

basic
cybersecurity
good practices

The training initiatives carried out by the ACN in support of students aimed to foster the development of cybersecurity skills needed by enterprises and Public Administrations. In this context, cooperation with the National Interuniversity Consortium for Informatics (CINI) continued in 2025 through the organisation and monitoring of national initiatives and competitions in cybersecurity and technological innovation, with the aim of identifying young talent and promoting female empowerment.

Within this framework, the Agency supported CINI conferences, seminars and training programs, including programs such as CyberChallenge, CyberCup and OliCyber. These initiatives also enabled the selection of the national cyber defenders' team, TeamItaly, which won the 2025 European Cybersecurity Challenge organised by ENISA, and the Italian participants to the first International Cybersecurity Olympiad, who achieved outstanding results.

Specific attention was also devoted to vulnerable groups through targeted training initiatives for people with disabilities, developed in cooperation with non-profit foundations, with the aim of promoting cyber hygiene and employability. Finally, the Agency launched initiatives to support ITS programs in developing advanced cybersecurity skills to meet industry needs. Actions included funding 125 scholarships worth €500.000 and participating in outreach events involving over 1.000

students, teachers, and industry representatives in Sardinia and Apulia.

Growing reliance on technology makes cyber risk awareness more critical, as threats increasingly affected Public Administrations, businesses, and citizens. The rising sophistication of attacks highlighted the need to strengthen cybersecurity culture, with the Agency playing a key role in promoting safe and responsible behavior. In 2025, awareness campaigns gained increasing relevance due to the range and continuous updating of the topics addressed and to their ability to reach a wider and more diverse audience. These initiatives made a significant contribution to the promotion of a mature and shared digital security culture and reinforced the role of the ACN as a primary institutional reference.

In the same period, the Agency updated the report "The Cyber Threat to the Healthcare Sector" and continued targeted outreach activities to raise awareness of cyber risks in the healthcare domain. Through a series of events held across several Italian regions, the initiative reached around 4.000 professionals working in hospitals and healthcare facilities. At the same time, the Roadshow PMI initiative continued, engaging small and medium sized enterprises across multiple cities to promote cyber risk awareness and effective protection measures.

The year 2025 also confirmed the value of collaborative

models for awareness raising activities, with expanded cooperation involving professional associations and institutional partners. Training initiatives were further enriched through dedicated sessions for senior IT officials from key national institutions. In parallel, the Agency contributed to digital inclusion efforts by supporting the National Network of Digital Facilitation Services, providing training to digital facilitators who then disseminated cybersecurity knowledge within local communities, thereby supporting broader digital awareness and inclusion.

Lastly, to further strengthen Italy's presence in EU and international forums in this area, the ACN took part in awareness raising activities promoted by ENISA, including meetings of the Awareness Raising and Cyber-Hygiene Ad-Hoc Working Group and the second

European cybersecurity awareness conference held in Zagreb in November under the title "Empowering the Human Element". Participation in these initiatives helped reinforce institutional cooperation with EU bodies and explore how emerging technologies and innovative learning approaches can enhance cybersecurity awareness across Europe.

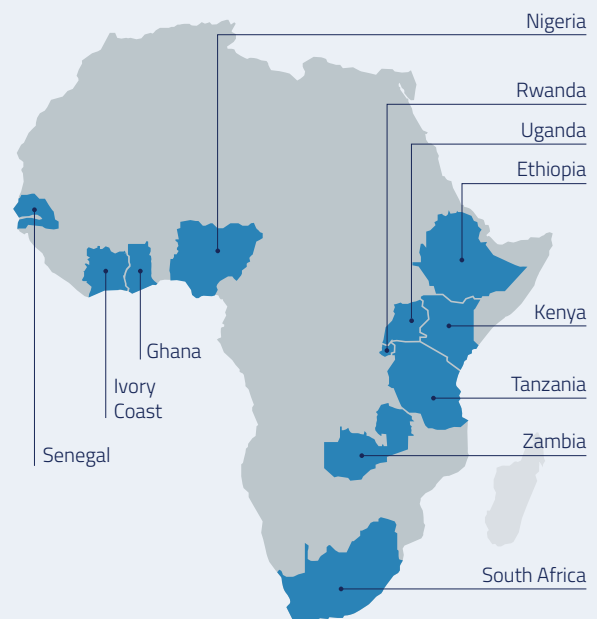
The ACN also contributed to the launch of the AKADIMOS project, funded under the Digital Europe Programme, which aims to establish the European Cybersecurity Skills Academy as a single reference point for cybersecurity training in the EU. Working with partners from five European countries, the Agency focused on defining a data sharing model to support the future development of an information system collecting training courses and programs at European level.

CyberBridge: strategic training for digital resilience in Africa

In cooperation with the Med-Or Italian Foundation, the ACN launched CyberBridge, an advanced training program aimed at strengthening cybersecurity skills among public officials from African countries. The initiative, launched in November 2025 and running until May 2026, is supported by the Italian Ministry of Foreign Affairs and International Cooperation and aligns with the "Piano Mattei per l'Africa", with the goal of reinforcing strategic dialogue between Italy and the African continent in the field of cybersecurity.

The program delivered structured training to 30 officials from central Public Administrations in 11 partner African countries. The training paths combine technical skills and policy capabilities, promoting a multi-level approach to digital resilience that integrates specialised training, cyber diplomacy and governance of cyberspace.

11 partner countries



8. Implementation status of the 2022-2026 National Cybersecurity Strategy

The National Cybersecurity Strategy serves as the guiding framework for strengthening the country's cyber security and resilience. Since its adoption, the implementation of the 2022-2026 Strategy has been realized thanks to the active involvement of Public Administrations and through the support of dedicated Strategy Funds.

In its coordination and monitoring role, the ACN continued to promote the Strategy as a key instrument for the progressive improvement of the national cybersecurity posture. In 2025, the number of beneficiary Administrations was further expanded to include Regions, Autonomous Provinces and independent administrative authorities. Building on established working methods, the Agency provided technical support throughout the implementation lifecycle and ensured regular monitoring of the progress achieved and of the resources allocated.

In line with previous assessments, Administrations involved in the implementation of the National

Cybersecurity Strategy were invited to submit project proposals, which were evaluated by the ACN based on their consistency with the measures set out in the Implementation Plan and on their contribution to strengthening both the cybersecurity posture of individual Public Administrations and the overall resilience of the national digital ecosystem.

In the year under review, this assessment involved 19 Public Administrations, including 16 central Administrations and 3 Regions or Autonomous Provinces, which submitted projects related to 10 measures of the Implementation Plan. Overall, 35 interventions were considered eligible for funding. Implementation of the Strategy is supported not only by dedicated national funds but also by additional European funding sources and by resources allocated directly by the Administrations.

On the proposal of the ACN and in agreement with the Ministry of Economy and Finance, the Prime Minister's Decree of 4 July 2025 was adopted, allocating a total of 57,6 million euros for the 2025-2027 period.

2025-2027 Strategy Funds

Fund for the implementation of the National Cybersecurity Strategy

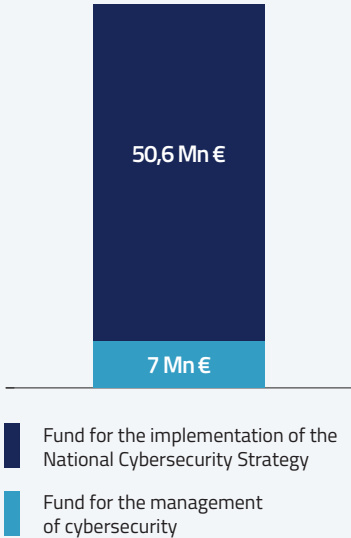
It finances investments aimed at achieving digital technological autonomy and enhancing the cybersecurity of national information systems.

Fund for the management of cybersecurity

It finances the operational management of projects supporting the implementation of the National Cybersecurity Strategy.



The ACN directs, coordinates, and monitors the implementation of the Strategy, including through periodic assessments of Administrations’ financial needs to allocate funds via Prime Ministerial Decrees.



The decree allocated 91 percent of funding to central Public Administrations responsible for core State functions such as justice, economic policy and national security, as shown in Figure 13. For the first time, the beneficiaries also included several independent administrative authorities, with the aim of strengthening the cybersecurity of bodies entrusted with essential responsibilities in the protection of fundamental rights and sectoral regulation. The ACN was also included among the beneficiaries, with actions designed to enhance the cybersecurity of the country as a whole and to deliver benefits across the national cybersecurity ecosystem.

The 2025 needs assessment confirms the trend toward broader and more widespread implementation of the National Cybersecurity Strategy, with increased involvement of local Public Administrations, including

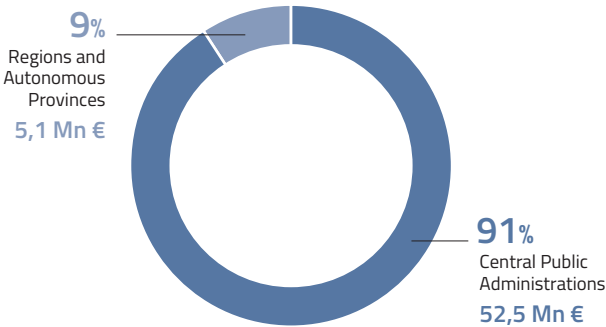


Figure 13 – Distribution of financial resources between central and local Administrations

new ones and ensuring coverage across the entire national territory. The allocation of resources for 2025-2027 is further detailed in Figure 14, which shows the distribution of funds by administrative category.

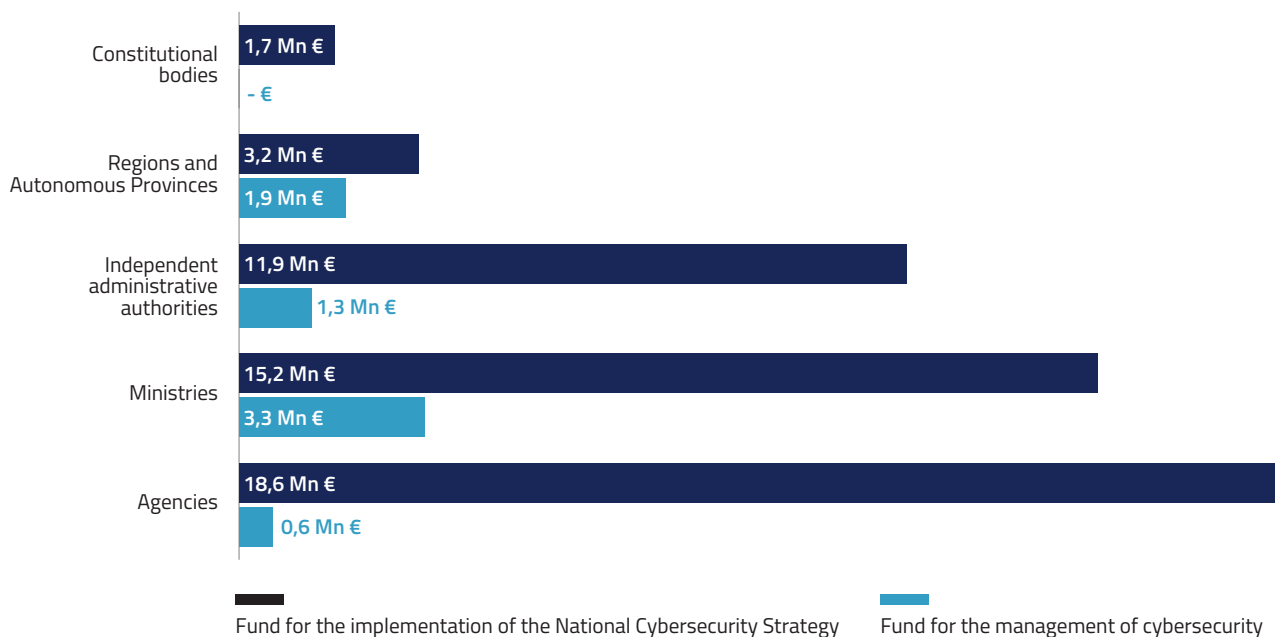


Figure 14 – Distribution of financial resources by type of beneficiary administration

In 2025, of the 82 measures included in the 2022-2026 National Cybersecurity Strategy Implementation Plan, 60 have been completed, while 22 are in progress (Figure 15). This result, achieved through close institutional

cooperation among all responsible Public Administrations, confirms the growing awareness of cybersecurity across the Italian public sector.

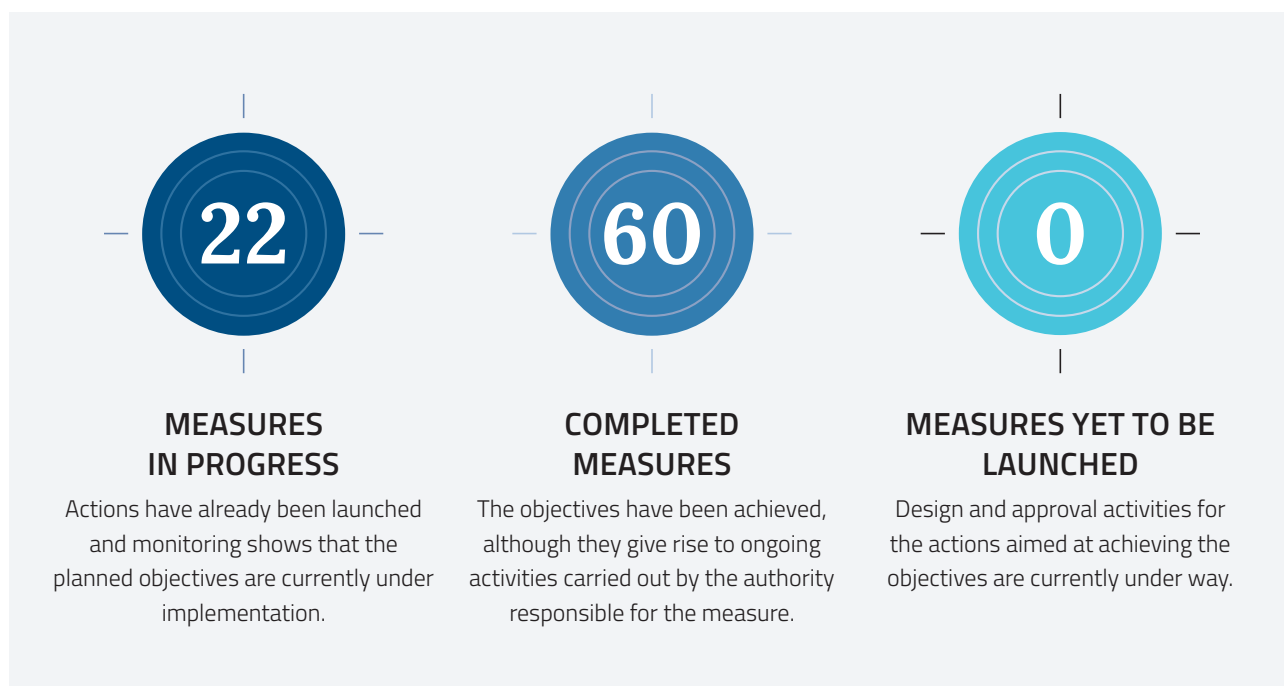


Figure 15 – 2025 implementation status of measures

During the year under review, the positive effects of initiatives launched in previous years became evident. Implemented measures strengthened the cybersecurity posture of Administrations through the adoption of technological tools, the introduction of new processes and organisational arrangements, together with the continued development of skills and awareness of cyber risks.

2025 also marked a pivotal year for the Strategy, with the launch of an assessment of the country's maturity level in preparation for the forthcoming update of the strategic framework. The future Strategy will build on the results achieved so far while anticipating developments in the digital sector, the international environment and the cybersecurity regulatory landscape.

9. The Agency in 2025

In 2025 the ACN consolidated across all aspects of its organisational structure, including human resources, financial management, technological systems and external communication.

As responsibilities expanded, the Agency continued to invest in attracting and developing highly qualified professionals, while improving and simplifying internal processes. The Agency continued its path of progressive growth in 2025 through the adoption of organisational, recruitment and staff development approaches designed to address new challenges arising from technological innovation, changes in the national and EU cybersecurity regulatory framework and the expansion of the Agency's institutional responsibilities.

The organisational structure was updated through the integration of the Cryptography Service, in connection with the establishment of the National Cryptography Centre, the revision of functions related to the role of National Cybersecurity Certification Authority and targeted measures to streamline, merge and reorganise Services and Divisions, resulting in a redesigned organisational chart. At the same time, the ACN updated its 2024-2026 Strategic Plan. Thanks also to new hires in 2025, it continues to rely on a particularly young and highly qualified workforce. The average age of employees is around 43 years. By December 31st 2025, the ACN could rely on 422 staff members. Most personnel have a university-level education (79%), with around 71% holding at least a master's degree.

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The 2024-2026 Strategic Plan

The Plan is the Agency's single document for programming, governance and coordination, within which the five strategic goals have cross-cutting relevance. It sets out both the institutional purposes and public mission of the ACN, as well as its organisational structure and operational objectives, ensuring coherence with available resources while promoting efficiency and simplification of administrative action. The Plan also serves as a useful tool for the progressive monitoring of results and for achieving the highest possible alignment between institutional objectives and individual staff contributions.

For the 2024-2026 period, the ACN has oriented its action towards the creation of public value by supporting the modernisation of infrastructures, strengthening the country's cyber resilience, reducing vulnerabilities and increasing technological autonomy and independence.

5 GOALS



Protection
of national
strategic assets



Response to national
and transnational cyber
threats, incidents
and crises



Secure
development
of digital technologies



Strengthening
cybersecurity
cooperation



Becoming a centre of
excellence with flexible
organizational model

Careful management of financial resources and the progressive enhancement of technological capabilities enabled the ACN to deliver increasingly advanced services. The Agency’s annual budget, which provides the structural financial resources required for the ordinary conduct of its institutional tasks, is made up of its ordinary allocation as established by Law Decree

No. 82/2021, as subsequently adjusted by further expenditure authorisations introduced through specific legislative provisions. In this context, the 2025-2028 period shows a gradual increase in financial resources, reaching completion in 2027, in parallel with the structural growth of the Agency in terms of the functions and responsibilities assigned to it.



Figure 16 – 2025-2028 ACN annual budget

During 2025, the ACN continued to consolidate and further develop its technological systems, supporting the implementation of new regulatory obligations and strengthening coordination and supervisory capabilities. These efforts contributed to greater efficiency in the Agency’s institutional activities, in particular with the further implementation of the platform dedicated to the management of NIS entities.

At the same time, the Agency strengthened its external communication along four complementary lines: the continuous updating of the institutional website as an official and reliable repository of documents, news and guidelines; an active presence on social media to engage the public and amplify information of general interest; the strengthening of relations with the press and media; and the dissemination of communication campaigns aimed at ensuring clear, coherent and wide ranging coverage of the ACN’s activities.



Website

Visits: 2,1 Mn (+218%)

News: 170



Social

LinkedIn:
6 Mn views
112.000 followers (+40%)

YouTube:
+69% subscriptions
1,2 Mn views



Media

Press quotes: 2.600

Articles: 4.000

Interviews to senior and top management: 200

